

AQUA OTTER

WATER SOLUTIONS · INDIANA + MICHIGAN

FREE HOMEOWNER GUIDE

10 Signs Your Water Is Damaging Your Home.

Most homeowners can't see what's happening to their water until it's costing them thousands. This guide shows you exactly what to look for, what each sign costs you every month, and how to fix it.

WHAT'S INSIDE

10 visible warning signs · The chemistry behind each one · Real monthly cost estimates · Which treatment stage solves it

WRITTEN BY

The Aqua Otter Field Team

5,000+ installs across Indiana + Michigan

Free water test included with every consultation

BEFORE WE GET INTO THE SIGNS

Why this guide exists.

Water is the only utility that touches every appliance, every fixture, every load of laundry, every glass you drink, and every shower you take. When something is wrong with it, the damage compounds quietly — month after month, year after year — until the bill arrives in the form of a dead water heater, ruined dishwasher, stained tub, or doctor visit.

The thing is, most water problems are visible if you know what to look for. The signs are right there on your fixtures, in your laundry, on your skin, and at the tip of your tongue. You just have to know how to read them.

This guide walks you through 10 of the most common warning signs. For each, you'll see what causes it at the chemistry level, what it actually costs you, and which treatment stage fixes it. By the end, you'll be able to walk through your own home and diagnose roughly what's in your water — without an expensive lab test.

WANT TO SKIP THE GUESSWORK?

We'll come out, run a free 12-point water test on your tap, and tell you exactly what's in your water and what it would take to fix.

Schedule yours: myaquatoter.com/get-started · (317) 983-5919

Spotty dishes & cloudy glassware

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Glasses come out of the dishwasher with white film or visible water-spot rings. Polishing doesn't fix it for long.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Calcium and magnesium hardness above 7 grains per gallon. The minerals stay behind as the water dries.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

\$15–\$30/month in extra detergent, rinse aid, and replaced glassware over a few years.

HOW WE FIX IT

Stage 3 ion-exchange softener swaps every hardness ion for sodium. Glassware comes out clean on the first run.

Soap that won't lather (skin & hair feel filmy)

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

You use twice the shampoo and soap to feel clean. After showering, skin feels itchy, hair feels weighed down.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Hardness ions bind with soap and form scum (soap curd) instead of lather.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

2× soap/shampoo consumption (\$25–\$60/mo for a family) plus skin-care products to compensate.

HOW WE FIX IT

Soft water makes soap go further by 50–75%. Most homeowners cut their soap budget in half.

Orange or rust stains on porcelain

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Toilets, tubs, sinks develop orange-brown stains that come back days after cleaning.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Dissolved iron oxidizing on contact with air. Common on well water and aging municipal lines.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Stains permanently etch porcelain over time. Premature fixture replacement: \$400–\$2,000.

HOW WE FIX IT

Stage 1 sediment + Stage 3 softener (with iron-grade resin) removes iron up to 3 ppm at the source.

Chlorine smell at the tap

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Water smells like a swimming pool. Stronger first thing in the morning or after the city flushes the lines.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Free chlorine or chloramine residual from municipal disinfection. Your lungs are absorbing it during showers.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Skin and respiratory irritation for sensitive families. Chlorine also strips the natural oils from your skin.

HOW WE FIX IT

Stage 2 catalytic carbon block adsorbs both chlorine and chloramine. Water tastes and smells like nothing.

Rotten-egg / sulfur odor

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

The water smells like sulfur, especially the hot side. The odor is worst right after a faucet has been off for hours.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Hydrogen sulfide gas (H₂S) from anaerobic bacteria, common in well water and aging water heaters.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Corrodes copper plumbing, brass valves, and water-heater anode rods. Replacement: \$800–\$3,000.

HOW WE FIX IT

Air-injection oxidation + carbon filtration eliminates H₂S entirely. Aqua Otter sizes this to your test results.

Scale buildup on showerheads, faucets, kettles

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Crusty white-gray rings on every fixture. Showerhead spray pattern weakens within months. Kettle has a chalky lining.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Calcium carbonate crystallizing as water evaporates. The same scale builds up where you can't see it — inside pipes, water heaters, dishwashers.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

A scaled water heater uses 20–30% more energy and lasts half as long. \$400–\$1,500 in replacement + utility costs.

HOW WE FIX IT

Soft water leaves zero scale. Existing scale dissolves over weeks once supply stops feeding it.

Appliances dying years early

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Dishwashers and water heaters fail at 6–8 years instead of 12–15. Heating elements coated in white scale when serviced.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Scale insulates heating elements. They run hotter, work harder, and burn out.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Replacing a water heater + dishwasher 5 years early = \$2,500–\$4,000 over a decade. Multiply across the next 30 years.

HOW WE FIX IT

Treated water extends appliance life by 2× on average. Manufacturer warranties even cite hardness limits.

Your tap water tastes 'off' — flat, metallic, or chemical

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

You buy bottled water for drinking. Coffee tastes worse than at restaurants. Your kids refuse to drink from the tap.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Combination of chlorine, dissolved metals (iron, copper), and total dissolved solids (TDS).

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Bottled-water habit for a family of four: \$40–\$120/month. Plus the plastic.

HOW WE FIX IT

Stage 2 carbon + Stage 3 softener handle taste at the whole-house level. Add reverse osmosis at the kitchen sink for 99% pure drinking water.

Laundry that fades, stiffens, or grays over time

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Whites turn gray, towels feel stiff, dark colors fade fast. Detergent residue visible on freshly-washed clothes.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Hardness binds with detergent !' less cleaning power. Iron oxidation also stains fabrics yellow over time.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Clothes wear out 30–40% faster. For a family of four: \$400–\$800/year in early-replacement cost.

HOW WE FIX IT

Soft water lets detergent actually clean. Whites stay white, colors stay vibrant, towels stay soft.

Pipe corrosion: blue-green stains, pinhole leaks, low pressure

WHAT YOU CAN SEE OR FEEL

Blue-green staining on white sinks and tubs. Mystery leaks at joints. Slow pressure loss over years.

WHAT'S CAUSING IT

Aggressive water (low pH or high TDS) leaching copper from your pipes. The blue stain is dissolved copper.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

Re-piping a 2,500 sq ft home: \$8,000–\$15,000. And one missed leak can cause water damage in the tens of thousands.

HOW WE FIX IT

pH neutralization + scale-inhibiting blends are added to the system based on your water test. We measure first, then engineer.

SO YOU SPOTTED SOME SIGNS.

What now?

If even one of these signs sounds familiar, your water is costing you something — every single month — that you'd never get an itemized bill for. The good news: it's almost always fixable, and the fix pays for itself.

Here's how Aqua Otter handles it:

01

Free in-home water test

We come to you and run a 12-point analysis on your actual tap water. No samples shipped to a lab. You see results in under 30 minutes.

02

Custom system design

Based on your water chemistry, your home's plumbing, and your family's usage — not a one-size-fits-all package.

03

Same-week installation

Our installers are W-2 employees, not subcontractors. Most homes are up and running in 2–4 hours.

04

Lifetime warranty

Parts, labor, and electronics. We manufacture our systems, so we stand behind them.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Schedule your free water test.

No commitment. No high-pressure pitch. We test, we tell you what's in there, and we leave you the report.

myaquaotter.com/get-started · (317) 983-5919

Pure water. Built right. Warranted for life.

We've designed, built, and installed over 5,000 water systems across Indiana and Michigan. Every one engineered for the home it sits in. Every one warranted for as long as you own that home.

WHAT WE STAND ON

- ✔ 5,000+ installs across IN + MI
- ✔ Manufacturer-direct: no middlemen, no markups
- ✔ W-2 install crew (not subcontractors)
- ✔ Lifetime warranty on parts, labor, electronics
- ✔ Free water test included with every consultation

PHONE

(317) 983-5919

WEB

myaquaotter.com

HOURS

Mon–Sat

